

Nicolas Pardo

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Education

2023–2028* **Ph.D.**, Education, University of Southern California, Rossier School of Education
2019–23 **A.B.** Psychology, Duke University

Research Experience

2023– Research Assistant, [EdPolicy Hub](#), University of Southern California
2022–2023 Research Intern, [NC Department of Public Instruction](#), Exceptional Children
Division
2022 Research Assistant, [Duke Culture Lab](#), Duke University

Awards & Honors

2022 - 2023 [Jacqueline A. Morris Fellowship for Child Policy Research](#)
2023 Winfred Quinton Holton Prize for Education Research (Top Honors), Duke University
2023 Dr. Phail Wynn Jr. Leadership in Education Award, Duke University
2019 - 2023 [Robertson Scholar](#), Full scholarship and joint leadership program between Duke
and University of North Carolina-Chapel Hill

Grants & Funding

2025 USC Rossier Internal Research Grant (\$1,000)
2024 - 2026 [WT Grant Foundation Mentoring Grant](#)(\$60,000)
Awarded as mentee. Co-application with mentor(Dr. Adam Kho)

Publications

 [Google Scholar](#)

Journal Articles

Smith, S. L., Dawson-Amoah, M., Tong, T., **Pardo, N.**, Alonso-Morris, E. A., & Kho, A. (2024).
Public School Choice Options in the United States. *Encyclopedia*, 4(1). <https://doi.org/10.3390/encyclopedia4010006>

*Expected.

Working papers

- Kho, A., Rabovsky, S., Smith, S., & **Pardo, N.** (n.d.-a). Alternatives for whom? trends in alternative school enrollment and student and staff characteristics.
- Kho, A., Tong, T., & **Pardo, N.** (n.d.-b). High school employment and academic & economic outcomes.
- Polikoff, M. S., **Pardo, Nicolas**, Byon, J., Saavedra, A., Rapaport, A., Silver, D., & Garland, M. (2025). The rainbow connection: Lgbt social networks and support for lgbt-inclusive education [R&R at International Journal of Public Opinion Research].

Briefs

- Polikoff, M., & **Pardo, Nicolas**. (2025, October). Who's Absent from School? A Two-State Examination of Trends in Absenteeism Before and After COVID-19 [American Enterprise Institute]. <https://www.aei.org/research-products/report/whos-absent-from-school-a-two-state-examination-of-trends-in-absenteeism-before-and-after-covid-19/>

† → Equal contribution

Talks

Posters

- Smith, S., Dawson-Amoah, M., Tong, T., **Pardo, N.**, Alonso-Morris, E. A., & Kho, A. (2024b, November). Public School Choice Options in the United States.
- Pardo, Nicolas**. (2023, May). NC Teacher Working Conditions and Attrition.
- Pardo, Nicolas**. (2025, March). District and School Allocation of ESSER Funds: Evidence from Washington State.

Selected Media Coverage

- 2025 The 74 Million, [Chronic Absenteeism's Post-COVID 'New Normal'](#) [B1]

Teaching

University of Southern California

- 2024 Teaching Assistant, Resourcing Schools for Excellence and Equity (EDUC 717)

Duke University

- 2024 Costanzo Teaching Fellow, Introductory Psychology (PSY 101)
Structured teaching fellowship with a focus on pedagogy for teaching assistants

Academic Service

2024 Committee Member, Rossier Faculty Hiring Committee

Professional Affiliations

[AEFP](#) Member
[AERA](#) Member
[UCEA](#) Member

Other Experience

2021 Instructional Support Specialist, [NC Education Corps](#), Wake County Public
 Schools
2020 Education Access and Equity Intern, Greater Charlotte Area Mutual Aid

Last updated: January 28, 2026